Leave Policy

Harbor & Pine Software (a fictional company for a portfolio project). Version 1.0, applies to all full-time employees.

1. Purpose and scope

This policy explains how much leave employees can take, how to request it, and what happens to a request after it is submitted. It applies to all full-time employees. Questions about this policy go to the HR team at hr@harborpine.example.

2. Annual leave

Every full-time employee has 26 working days of paid annual leave per calendar year. The allowance is stored in the leave system, and the system is the only source for the number of days an employee has left. Employees who join during the year receive a share of the allowance for the months they work.

Annual leave is counted in working days. A working day is any day from Monday to Friday that is not a public holiday. Saturdays, Sundays and public holidays inside a leave period are not deducted from the allowance. For example, a request from Monday to Friday in a week with one public holiday uses 4 days.

3. Carry-over

Up to 5 unused annual leave days can be carried over into the next calendar year. Carried-over days must be used by 31 March. Days that are not used by then expire. Any unused days above 5 expire on 31 December.

4. How to request leave

- Submit the request in the leave system with the start date, the end date and the type of leave. A reason is optional.
- The system calculates the number of working days and checks that you have enough days left.
- A request is rejected by the system if it overlaps with another pending or approved request of yours. Two requests cannot cover the same day.
- Employees should submit requests at least 10 working days before the start date for leave longer than 5 working days, and at least 3 working days before for shorter leave.
- Your manager approves or rejects a pending request, normally within 5 working days.

Days are reserved from your balance as soon as you submit a request. If the request is rejected or cancelled, the days are returned to your balance.

5. Status of a request

A request moves through these statuses: **Pending** after submission, then **Approved**, **Rejected** or **Cancelled**. Rejected and Cancelled are final, and a request in a final status cannot be changed. Every status change is recorded in the history of the request.

6. Cancelling leave

- You can cancel a pending request at any time.

- You can cancel an approved request only before its start date. Once leave has started, it cannot be cancelled.
- Cancelling a request returns its days to your balance.

7. Sick leave

Every employee has 10 paid sick days per calendar year. Tell your manager on the first day of absence, before the start of the working day if possible. A medical certificate is required from the fourth consecutive sick day. Sick days are counted in working days in the same way as annual leave.

8. Special leave

Employees can take the following paid special leave in addition to annual leave. Special leave is approved by the manager and does not reduce the annual leave allowance.

- Own wedding: 3 working days.
- Death of a close family member (spouse, partner, child, parent, brother or sister): 3 working days.
- Moving to a new home: 1 working day, once per calendar year.

9. Unpaid leave

An employee can request up to 10 working days of unpaid leave per calendar year. Unpaid leave must be approved by both the manager and the HR director, and is requested at least 20 working days in advance.

10. Public holidays

Public holidays follow the official national calendar. The leave system holds the list of public holidays for the year. A public holiday is never deducted from any leave allowance, even if it falls inside a leave period.